

ULYSSES

Alfred, Lord Tennyson

MCQ TEST

Full Marks: 60

Class – XII

Time: 1 Hour

Instructions

1. Answer all the questions.
2. Each question carries 1 mark.
3. Choose the correct answer from the alternatives given.
4. The questions are divided into three sections according to difficulty level.

SECTION A

Questions 1–20

20 × 1 = 20

1. Who wrote the poem “Ulysses”?

- | | |
|------------------------|--------------------------|
| a) William Shakespeare | b) Alfred, Lord Tennyson |
| c) John Keats | d) Robert Browning |

2. Who is the speaker in the poem?

- | | |
|---------------|-------------|
| a) Telemachus | b) Achilles |
| c) Ulysses | d) A sailor |

3. Ulysses is a/an—

- | | |
|-------------|-----------|
| a) farmer | b) king |
| c) merchant | d) sailor |

4. Ulysses is living among—

- | | |
|-------------------|-----------------|
| a) fertile fields | b) barren crags |
| c) green forests | d) busy streets |

5. Ulysses is married to—

- | | |
|-------------|-----------|
| a) Helen | b) Circe |
| c) Penelope | d) Athena |

6. Ulysses describes his wife as—

- | | |
|----------------------|------------------|
| a) a young wife | b) an aged wife |
| c) a beautiful queen | d) a cruel woman |

7. **Ulysses says that his people mainly–**
 - a) travel and explore
 - b) fight wars
 - c) hoard, sleep and feed
 - d) study knowledge
8. **Ulysses says, “I cannot rest from–”**
 - a) work
 - b) war
 - c) travel
 - d) sleep
9. **Ulysses wants to “drink life to the–”**
 - a) end
 - b) lees
 - c) beginning
 - d) shore
10. **Ulysses has experienced–**
 - a) only happiness
 - b) only suffering
 - c) both joy and suffering
 - d) neither joy nor suffering
11. **Ulysses says, “I am become a–”**
 - a) king
 - b) warrior
 - c) name
 - d) legend
12. **Ulysses has seen many–**
 - a) cities of men
 - b) deserts only
 - c) mountains only
 - d) palaces only
13. **Ulysses fought at–**
 - a) Rome
 - b) Troy
 - c) London
 - d) Athens
14. **Who is Telemachus?**
 - a) Ulysses’ father
 - b) Ulysses’ son
 - c) Ulysses’ brother
 - d) Ulysses’ friend
15. **Ulysses leaves his sceptre and isle to–**
 - a) Achilles
 - b) Penelope
 - c) Telemachus
 - d) his mariners
16. **Ulysses’ vessel is waiting at the–**
 - a) palace
 - b) port
 - c) battlefield
 - d) mountain

17. Ulysses calls his sailors his–

- a) enemies
- b) servants
- c) mariners
- d) subjects

18. Ulysses says that he and his mariners are–

- a) young
- b) old
- c) wealthy
- d) inexperienced

19. What does Ulysses want to seek?

- a) Wealth
- b) A quiet life
- c) A newer world
- d) Political power

20. Which phrase concludes the poem?

- a) “To live and let live”
- b) “To strive, to seek, to find, and not to yield”
- c) “To rest and sleep”
- d) “To rule and conquer”

SECTION B

Questions 21–40

20 × 1 = 20

21. Why does Ulysses call himself an “idle king”?

- a) He has lost his kingdom.
- b) He finds no satisfaction in remaining inactive as a king.
- c) He does not want to be a king.
- d) His people have rejected him.

22. What does Ulysses dislike about his people?

- a) They are too adventurous.
- b) They are always fighting.
- c) They are concerned only with ordinary activities and do not understand him.
- d) They refuse to obey him.

23. What does “I will drink / Life to the lees” mean?

- a) Ulysses wants to avoid life.
- b) Ulysses wants to experience life fully.
- c) Ulysses wants to end his life.
- d) Ulysses wants to live peacefully.

24. “For always roaming with a hungry heart” suggests Ulysses’–

- a) physical hunger
- b) desire for wealth
- c) restless desire for experience
- d) fear of loneliness

25. **What does Ulysses mean by “I am a part of all that I have met”?**

- a) He has forgotten his experiences.
- b) His experiences have shaped his personality.
- c) He belongs to every kingdom.
- d) He wants to become a ruler everywhere.

26. **What does the “untravell’d world” represent?**

- a) The world already explored by Ulysses
- b) The unknown world and new experiences
- c) Ulysses’ homeland
- d) The world of the dead

27. **Why does Ulysses say, “How dull it is to pause, to make an end”?**

- a) He dislikes sleep.
- b) He believes stopping exploration makes life meaningless.
- c) He hates his kingdom.
- d) He wants to fight his people.

28. **What does “To rust unburnish’d” suggest?**

- a) Becoming useless through inactivity
- b) Becoming stronger through age
- c) Becoming famous
- d) Becoming wealthy

29. **What does Ulysses imply by “As tho’ to breathe were life”?**

- a) Merely existing is not enough to live a meaningful life.
- b) He wants to stop breathing.
- c) He thinks life is very easy.
- d) Breathing is the only purpose of life.

30. **Ulysses believes that every hour is—**

- | | |
|------------|----------------|
| a) wasted | b) saved |
| c) painful | d) meaningless |

31. **Telemachus is best suited to—**

- a) adventurous exploration
- b) ordinary duties and responsible government
- c) warfare
- d) sea voyages

32. **Which quality of Telemachus is emphasized in the poem?**

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| a) Recklessness | b) Prudence |
| c) Anger | d) Restlessness |

33. **Telemachus will make the “rugged people”–**
- a) wealthy
 - b) mild
 - c) adventurous
 - d) powerful
34. **Telemachus will subdue the people to–**
- a) war and glory
 - b) the useful and the good
 - c) wealth and luxury
 - d) travel and adventure
35. **What does “He works his work, I mine” indicate?**
- a) Telemachus and Ulysses have different roles.
 - b) Telemachus refuses to work.
 - c) Ulysses dislikes Telemachus.
 - d) Both have exactly the same duties.
36. **What have the mariners shared with Ulysses?**
- a) Only peaceful journeys
 - b) Toil, hardship, thought, thunder and sunshine
 - c) Wealth and political power
 - d) Family responsibilities
37. **“Free hearts, free foreheads” mainly suggests–**
- a) fear and sadness
 - b) courage and freedom
 - c) pride and wealth
 - d) weakness and old age
38. **What does Ulysses believe about old age?**
- a) It has no value.
 - b) It has its own honour and work.
 - c) It prevents all action.
 - d) It makes people useless.
39. **What does “some work of noble note” suggest?**
- a) Meaningful achievement is still possible.
 - b) Nothing can be achieved in old age.
 - c) Ulysses wants to become king again.
 - d) Ulysses wants to forget his past.
40. **Why does Ulysses ask his mariners to “Push off”?**
- a) To return to Ithaca
 - b) To begin another voyage of exploration
 - c) To escape from enemies
 - d) To attack Troy

SECTION C

Questions 41–60

20 × 1 = 20

41. **The contrast between Ulysses and his people mainly highlights Ulysses’–**
 - a) political weakness
 - b) dissatisfaction with ordinary, inactive life
 - c) hatred of his subjects
 - d) desire for wealth
42. **“I am become a name” most strongly suggests that Ulysses–**
 - a) has lost his personal identity
 - b) has gained lasting fame through his experiences
 - c) wants to change his name
 - d) has become unknown
43. **The metaphor of experience as an “arch” suggests that–**
 - a) experience closes the door to knowledge
 - b) each experience opens a view towards further unexplored possibilities
 - c) experience is dangerous
 - d) experience is limited to old age
44. **What is implied by “whose margin fades / For ever and for ever when I move”?**
 - a) The unknown becomes completely known.
 - b) New possibilities continue to appear as Ulysses explores.
 - c) Ulysses is moving away from his family.
 - d) The world is becoming smaller.
45. **The expression “this gray spirit” primarily emphasizes Ulysses’–**
 - a) youth
 - b) old age combined with continued desire
 - c) sadness
 - d) physical weakness
46. **Why does Ulysses want to follow knowledge “like a sinking star”?**
 - a) He wants to avoid knowledge.
 - b) He wants to pursue knowledge even though it continually remains beyond his complete reach.
 - c) He believes knowledge is dangerous.
 - d) He wants to become famous.

47. **The phrase “beyond the utmost bound of human thought” emphasizes–**
 - a) the desire to go beyond ordinary limits of knowledge
 - b) Ulysses’ rejection of learning
 - c) the importance of political power
 - d) Telemachus’ wisdom
48. **The presentation of Telemachus mainly serves to–**
 - a) show that he is exactly like Ulysses
 - b) contrast his practical nature with Ulysses’ adventurous nature
 - c) show that he is a poor ruler
 - d) prove that Ulysses dislikes his son
49. **Which statement best explains “He works his work, I mine”?**
 - a) Ulysses considers Telemachus useless.
 - b) Father and son have different but legitimate purposes in life.
 - c) Telemachus wants to accompany Ulysses.
 - d) Ulysses refuses to accept responsibility.
50. **The “dark, broad seas” mainly represent–**
 - a) certainty and safety
 - b) the unknown and the challenges of exploration
 - c) Ulysses’ kingdom
 - d) his peaceful retirement
51. **The mariners are important to Ulysses because they–**
 - a) have shared his adventurous experiences and hardships
 - b) are his political advisers
 - c) are his family members
 - d) are his enemies
52. **“Death closes all” is immediately followed by the idea that–**
 - a) nothing remains to be done
 - b) some noble work may still be accomplished before death
 - c) Ulysses must return home
 - d) old age should be avoided
53. **The reference to men who “strove with Gods” presents Ulysses and his mariners as–**
 - a) ordinary workers
 - b) heroic figures possessing extraordinary courage
 - c) peaceful rulers
 - d) fearful travellers

54. **What is the significance of the changing evening landscape near the end of the poem?**
- a) It suggests the approaching end of life while the desire for action continues.
 - b) It shows that Ulysses has lost his way.
 - c) It represents the beginning of his kingship.
 - d) It indicates that the journey is impossible.
55. **“’Tis not too late to seek a newer world” primarily expresses—**
- a) resignation
 - b) renewed determination despite old age
 - c) fear of death
 - d) rejection of adventure
56. **The journey in the poem can be understood not only as a physical journey but also as a journey towards—**
- a) wealth
 - b) greater knowledge and experience
 - c) political authority
 - d) domestic comfort
57. **The ending “not to yield” emphasizes Ulysses’—**
- a) willingness to surrender
 - b) perseverance in the face of age and difficulty
 - c) desire for retirement
 - d) fear of failure
58. **Which pair correctly represents the contrasting approaches of Ulysses and Telemachus?**
- a) Ulysses—adventure; Telemachus—duty
 - b) Ulysses—cowardice; Telemachus—anger
 - c) Ulysses—wealth; Telemachus—war
 - d) Ulysses—peace; Telemachus—travel
59. **The repeated emphasis on movement, travel and seeking primarily develops the theme of—**
- a) resignation to old age
 - b) the human desire for continuous growth and experience
 - c) political conflict
 - d) family disagreement
60. **Which interpretation best captures the central tension of the poem?**
- a) The conflict between wealth and poverty
 - b) The conflict between a settled life of duty and an individual desire for continued adventure and discovery
 - c) The conflict between two rival kingdoms
 - d) The conflict between youth and education

ANSWER KEY

For Teacher's Use

Easy

1. b
2. c
3. b
4. b
5. c
6. b
7. c
8. c
9. b
10. c
11. c
12. a
13. b
14. b
15. c
16. b
17. c
18. b
19. c
20. b

Moderate

21. b
22. c
23. b
24. c
25. b
26. b
27. b
28. a
29. a
30. b

31. b
32. b
33. b
34. b
35. a
36. b
37. b
38. b
39. a
40. b

Hard

41. b
42. b
43. b
44. b
45. b
46. b
47. a
48. b
49. b
50. b
51. a
52. b
53. b
54. a
55. b
56. b
57. b
58. a
59. b
60. b